

film review Half-Baked

MITHYA

Director: Rajat Kapoor
Starring: Naseerudin Shah, Ranvir Shorey

Imagine a *Godfather* lite shot in Alibaug. Throw in some easy living gangsters who drive out-of-date Mercedes, breakfast like champions, and drink tea in the middle of the night. Add a trying-to-be-sultry Neha Dhupia who dresses like a cross between Grace Kelly and Isadora Duncan and a bewhiskered Naseeruddin Shah who seems to have borrowed his wardrobe from a retired tango dancer.

In what is meant to be an ironic tale of Mumbai underworld-meets-Bollywood, Rajat Kapoor takes his twisted humour beyond the *Mixed Doubles* bedroom. Shorey



JUST AN ILLUSION: Dhupia and Shorey in *Mithya*

plays a Bollywood struggler who replaces a don he resembles. The movie is beautifully shot by Rafey Mahmood and designed by Meenal Agarwal, both part of Kapoor's talented team (the latter is his wife too). But it's neither too dark nor too comic for a dark comedy. The humour is not insane enough (as it was in *Bheja Fry*) and the suspense is not thrilling enough.

Shorey is good as the

actor who begins to believe he is a don and other Kapoor factory alumni such as Vinay Pathak and Saurabh Shukla keep the plot ticking. Kapoor, who has learnt the art of making a rupee stretch through years of scrounging around for *Private Detective* and *Raghu Romeo*, has evolved as a fine magnet for budding actors and trainee directors. But this film doesn't stick.

by Kaveer Banzai

dance Perfect Pose

DELHI With just lithe bodies to tell stories and arouse emotions, the journey of contemporary dancers has always been a tumultuous one, especially in India which has a rich heritage of classical dance.

As a repertory that has made its mark in various European countries the latest production from Attakalari



A Purushartha presentation Centre for Movement Arts—Purushartha, a multi media dance presentation—must be seen more as an international performance.

It explores the very meaning of one's existence, along with the choices that we make in life, through movement and digital imagery.

Director of the institute Jayachandran Palazhy and most of his dancers have tried to journey through the myriad emotions. Other collaborators include music composer Kunihiko Matsuo and sound engineer Naoki Hamanaka from Japan. An intimate experience, Purushartha is a fresh and innovative production. From February 16 at Kamani Auditorium.

by Nirmala Ravindran

Cinema at Large

A woman is beaten and raped by three thugs in an abandoned building in Franco de Pena's Polish language film *Your Name is Justine* (2005). In Miguel Bardem's (brother of actor Javier) Spanish thriller *Incautos* (2004), Pedro Almodovar's favourite actor Victoria Abril offers a grand scam to her former lover, a slick thief.

In the late great Krzysztof Kieslowski's *Three Colours: Blue* (1993), the first of the colours trilogy, a woman composer (played with a haunting sense of grief by the luminous Juliette Binoche) learns to cope with the trauma of losing



A still from the movie Viva Cuba her husband and child (a theme explored later in Alejandro González Iñárritu's *21 Grams*).

It's a world of international movies that does not owe its allegiance to the US, which to be fair is also increasingly recognising the mainstreaming of indie films. And it now comes 24X7 on World Movies, a new satellite channel. Launched this

month, the channel's movies may well liberate viewers vegetating on reruns of Hollywood blockbusters and Bollywood dramas.

As the world of movies gets more integrated with directors crossing continents to make movies in many languages (like Inaritu's *Babel*) and actors switching nations to work in English (Javier Bardem's work in *No Country for Old Men* is an example) no time could be better to bring home a different cinematic sensibility.

by Kaveer Banzai